SETUP GUIDE · MAC

Setting up The Assistant

Five short steps, and you only do it once. Each numbered line is one thing to do. Go in order.

BEFORE YOU START, YOU NEED

one

A Mac

Any recent Mac. A Windows guide comes later.

two

A Claude plan, Pro or higher

The Assistant runs on your own Claude account. The free plan doesn't include the part of Claude it lives in.

three

An external hard drive

Where your shoots are kept. If your photos live on your computer for now, it still works, and the Assistant will talk to you about it once.

four

The Assistant file

One file called **The-Assistant.zip**. Download it from **[PLACE: to decide]**. It lands in your Downloads folder. Leave it as it is: don't double-click it.

The five steps

1. Install Claude on your Mac
2. Make a folder for the Assistant
3. Add the Assistant to Claude
4. Let it work while you're away
5. Say hi

Stuck at any point? Send a screenshot of what you see to **[ADDRESS: to decide]**.

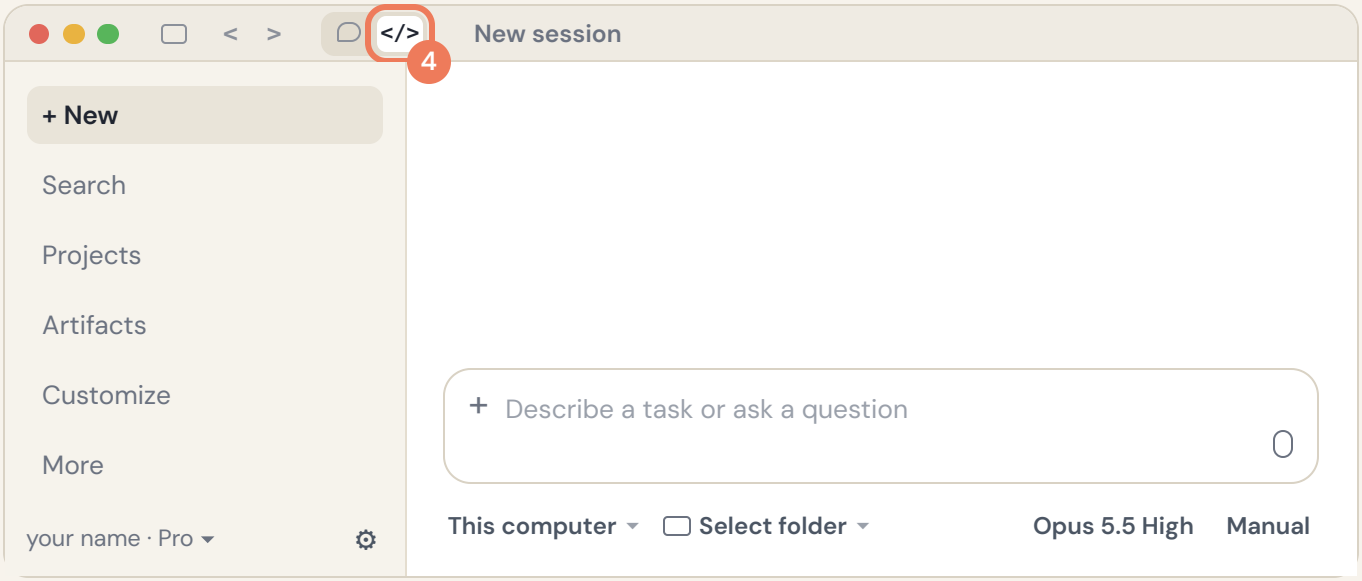
Steps 3 and 5 were walked through on a real Mac on November 5, 2026. The pictures are drawings, so your screen will look a little different. If a word on your screen doesn't match, send us a screenshot.

STEP 1 OF 5

1 Install Claude on your Mac

Claude is the app the Assistant lives inside. **Already have Claude on your Mac and you're signed in? Start at the small 4 on this page.**

1. Open Safari and go to **claude.ai/download**.
2. Click the download for **Mac**. When it finishes, open the downloaded file and follow what it shows to put **Claude** in your **Applications** folder.
3. Open **Claude** from Applications and **sign in** with your Claude account.
4. Look at the very top left of the window, on the same line as the red, yellow and green dots. At the right end of that line is a small box with two pictures in it: a speech bubble and `</>`. Click **</>**. (Not the two plain arrows just before it.) That part of Claude is called **Code**. You won't write any code.



Drawing. The </> picture is on the same line as the three colored dots.

You'll know it worked when the top of the window says **New session** and there's a message box at the bottom with a few small choices under it. A small box in the middle about "Choose environment" or "Connect GitHub" can be ignored. You don't need GitHub.

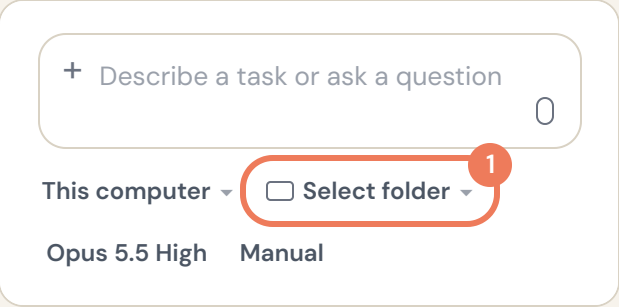
If Claude says your plan doesn't include this part, you need Pro or higher. **If it asks you to sign in online,** follow the link, then come back to the app.

STEP 2 OF 5

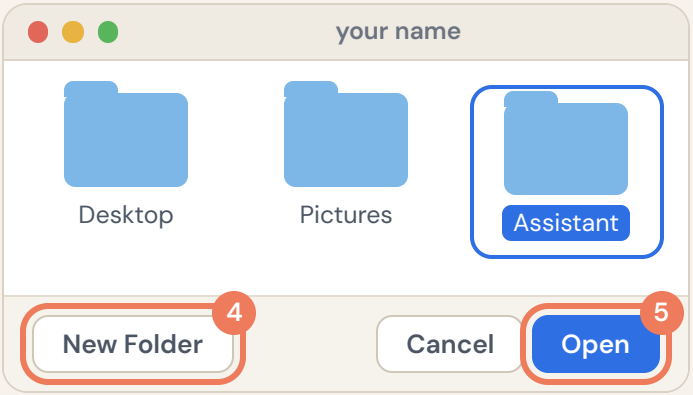
2 Make a folder for the Assistant

Claude needs a small folder to start in. This one is only for the Assistant's own use. **Your photos never go in this folder.**

1. Under the message box, click the choice with a small **folder** picture in front of it.
2. Click **Open folder…** A window opens showing your files.
3. Press Command + Shift + H. That jumps to your **home folder**, the one with your name on it.
4. Click **New Folder** at the bottom left. Type **Assistant** and click **Create**.
5. With the new **Assistant** folder selected, click **Open**.



Drawing. The folder choice. It may say Select folder, or the name of a folder you've used before.



Drawing. Your home folder, with the new folder in it.

You'll know it worked when the folder choice under the message box now says **Assistant**.

Not in Documents, Desktop or Downloads. Your Mac guards those three and can block Claude from working in them ("Couldn't access Documents"). Your home folder has no such guard. (The file you saved in Downloads is fine where it is.) You'll come back to this same folder every time you open the Assistant.

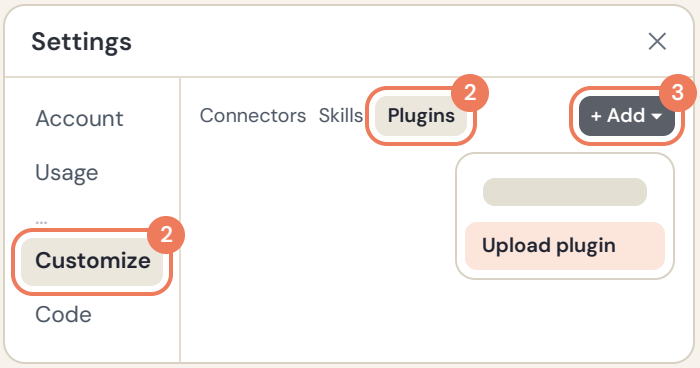
STEP 3 OF 5

3 Add the Assistant to Claude

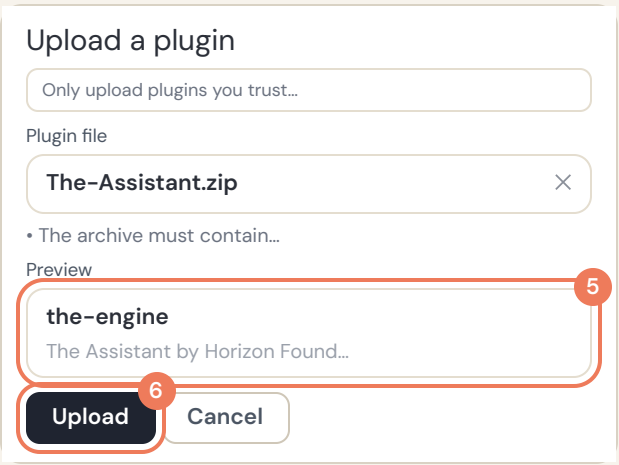
You add the Assistant from Claude's own **Settings**, using the file you downloaded. **Nothing gets typed.**

Installed "The Engine" from us before? Message us at [ADDRESS: to decide] before you go on. Never had it? Carry on.

1. At the very bottom left, at the right end of the line with your name, click the small **gear**. A box called **Settings** opens.
2. In the Settings box, find **Customize** in its list on the left, near the bottom. Click it, then click **Plugins** at the top. (Landed on Connectors? Leave its buttons alone.)
3. Click the dark **+ Add** button at the far top right, then **Upload plugin** (not Add marketplace).
4. Under **Plugin file**, choose **The-Assistant.zip** from your Downloads folder.
5. Check two things: **no line with a red !**, and the **Preview** says **the-engine**, "The Assistant by Horizon Found…" (the-engine is its behind-the-scenes name.)
6. Click the black **Upload** button, then close Settings with its **X**.



Drawing. Your + Add list may have more lines. Click the one about uploading a plugin.



Drawing. The two grey notes are always there. They are not errors.

The file is good when there is no red ! and Upload is black, not grey. The real proof is Step 5.

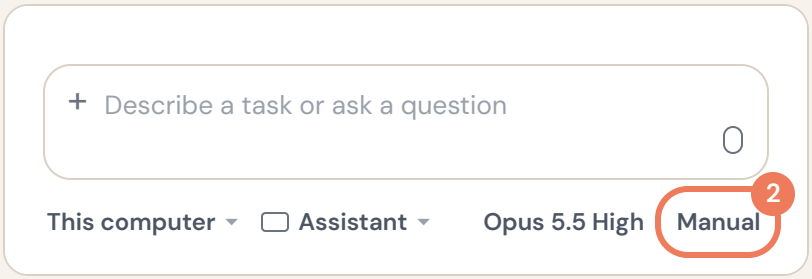
A red ! that says "Plugin failed validation"? Stop and send a screenshot to [ADDRESS: to decide]. That one is ours to fix. **"This marketplace is already added"?** Cancel, then + Add, Upload plugin. **"The Engine" with an Add button?** Leave it. It's an old copy.

STEP 4 OF 5

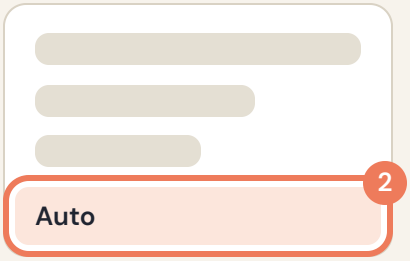
4 Let it work while you're away

This step lets a backup finish while you're out of the room. Without it, Claude may stop and ask your permission before each thing it does.

1. Look under the message box, at the right. After the name of the Claude you're using (ours said Opus 5.5), there is one word. If it says **Auto**, you're done with this step.
2. If it says anything else, click that word. In the list that opens, click **Auto**.



Drawing. The word is at the right, under the message box.



Drawing. Your list may have other words in it. Auto is the one to click.

You'll know it worked when that word says **Auto**. Glance at it each time you start; if it has changed, set it back.

Is this safe? Auto means Claude does the backup's steps without asking each time, with its own safety checks running. And the Assistant has one rule it never breaks, in any mode: **nothing on your memory card is ever deleted, moved or changed.**

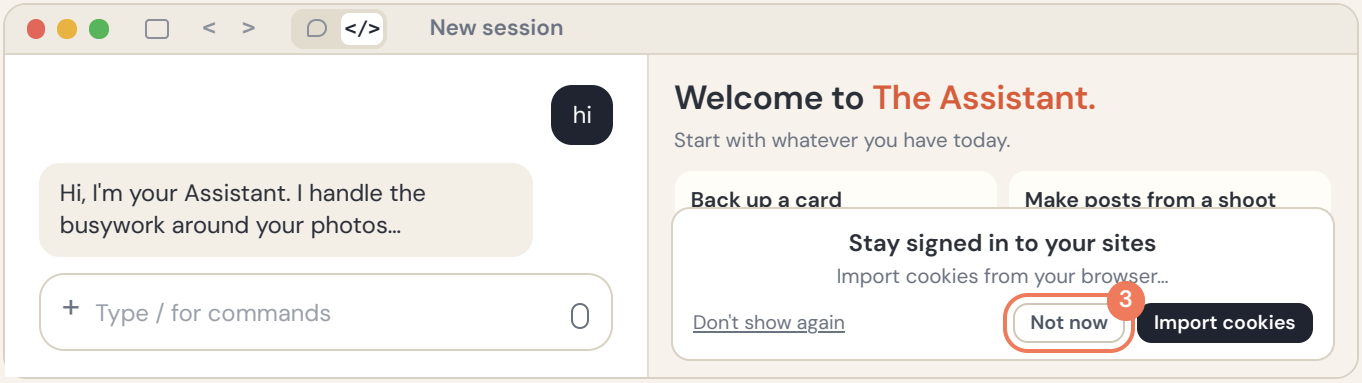
Don't see Auto in the list? Click the name just left of that word (ours said Opus 5.5), pick the newest one in the list, then look again.

STEP 5 OF 5

5 Say hi

That's the setup. Now meet your Assistant.

1. Click inside the message box, type **hi** and press **Return**.
2. Give it up to a minute the first time. A few grey lines show in the chat ("Ran 2 commands", "Opened browser"): nothing to click. Then it introduces itself, and its home page opens beside the chat.
3. Claude may offer to copy your browser's sign-ins ("Stay signed in to your sites"). Click **Not now** or **Don't show again**. Clicked Import cookies by mistake? Click **Cancel** in the next box.



Drawing. The chat on the left, the Assistant's home page on the right, and the pop-up to dismiss.

Things you might see

A window from Apple about developer tools	Click **Install** and follow Apple's steps. It can take a while. When it's finished, come back and say **hi** again. It's one free piece from Apple the Assistant runs on.
You said hi and no page opened beside the chat	Click **+ New** (top of the left column), check the folder under the message box says **Assistant**, say hi again. Still nothing? Screenshot to **[ADDRESS: to decide]**.
"Couldn't access Documents"	Don't click Open System Settings. Close the box. Go back to Step 2, make the folder in your home folder, and say hi again.

You're set up. Next time: open Claude, click **</>**, click **+ New**, check the folder under the message box says **Assistant**, type **hi**.

YOU'RE IN

Two good places to start

You don't need a memory card to begin. Talk to the Assistant in your own words.

Photos you've already finished

Edited and exported, sitting in a folder.

1. On the home page, click **Make posts from a shoot**.
2. A box opens with a few words and a **Copy** button. Click Copy, click in the chat's message box, press Command + V, then Return. (The first time the words are **set up my Assistant folder**: that makes a second folder, on your photo drive, for your posts.)
3. Click **Select the folder with your finished photos** and pick your exports.
4. Type **make my posts** in the chat and press Return.

You get single posts, a carousel and stories sized for Instagram, and a reel laid out in CapCut for you to finish (you'll need the CapCut app). The Assistant works from its own copies; your originals aren't moved or changed.

A memory card with new photos

Straight out of the camera.

1. Put the card in and plug in your drive.
2. Type **backup now** in the chat.
3. The first time, your Mac may ask whether Claude may read your card or drive (click **Allow**), and the Assistant asks a few setup questions. After that, it's one quick screen each time.
4. When it says **You can walk away**, walk away.

When you're back, click **Show the report** in the chat. Every photo is copied and checked, sorted into named shoots, with six sneak peeks picked to edit first.

If something isn't right

The page beside the chat is blank, or shows a play button	Don't press the play button. Type **show the Assistant** and the page comes back.
Claude keeps stopping to ask permission	Step 4 slipped back. Say yes to the one on screen, then set the word under the message box back to **Auto**.
A backup stopped	The Assistant says why, first thing. Fix that (plug the drive in, clear space) and say **backup now** again. Nothing is copied twice.
We tell you there's an update	We'll send a new file and the steps with it.
You're not sure what to do next	Say **hi**. It tells you where things stand and what you can say.

Three promises: nothing on your memory card is ever changed. Nothing is ever deleted. Nothing is ever posted or sent for you.